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Page 3: Arrange It

Arrange Person

Maria's
Childhood

Maria was born in Texas in 1920.

Maria attended school only through second grade.

Maria began working in the fields at age 8 and married at 15.

Maria the
Adult

Some of the places the family lived and worked were California, Colorado and Utah.

The Moreno's car was their only permanent home as they followed the crops.

Maria's son began working at age 5.

Not all of Maria's children survived. Some were born without medical support.

Page 4: Chart It

Moved to Action Chart It!

Describe the wages earned by Maria and other farmworkers.	Extremely low; The family of 4 only made \$114 a week, while others made 90 cents an hour
What evidence did you see that contrasts the situation of the farmworkers from that of the rest of the nation?	Farmers struggled to feed their families while the rest of the U.S. was experiencing a postwar abundance of goods
	The labor was harsh, and workers were often given no notice before being let go and were

Describe the working conditions you see in the historic photographs and hear in the interviews.	treated "no better than dogs."
What natural catastrophe upended the Moreno family in 1958?	A flood that left the water ankle-deep and destroyed the worker's belongings
Why couldn't thousands of workers access emergency food supplies at the time of the flooding?	The strict rules stated that anyone able to work was ineligible for aid, even if there was no work available for them to do.

Page 5: Chart It

Maria, The Activist Chart

What personal experiences caused Maria to speak out?	Maria was driven after her 19-year-old son went blind for three days because he had to save food for the other 11 children. This happened after the flood left the family with no food or help.
What was the major challenge facing the AWOC in organizing farmworkers?	The biggest obstacle was the segregation of camps and work crews, which purposely prevented different ethnic groups from uniting.
How was Maria a "first" and what message did she share?	She was the first woman farmworker to be hired as a professional union organizer. Her message was that workers must organize and fight together to get their way.

Page 7: Chart It

ChartHistoryMaker

	Maria Moreno	My History Maker: My dad. Scott Lomeli
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Backstory (Where is this person from, describe her/his background)	Born in Texas in 1920 to a farmworking family. Attended school until 2nd grade and began working in the fields at age 8.	Born and raised in CA. Graduated from high school and worked construction full-time to earn a pension after 30 years. Lived within his means and now owns two properties (one of which we live in). Grew up in the lower class.
What is the issue this person is impacting?	Labor rights and hunger. She fought for fair wages, working conditions, and the right for farmworkers to receive emergency food aid when needed.	Financial Independence and the "American Dream" by proving that a lower-profile job can still create generational wealth.
What experiences led this person to take action?	After a flood in 1958, her family began to starve, and her 19-year-old son went blind for three days due to starvation.	He was influenced to purchase a home early in life, which took most of his income. He got a job straight out of high school and never looked back.
How does this person take action?	She became the first female farmworker hired as a union organizer for the AWOG. She used speeches and her voice to motivate workers from different backgrounds.	He lived within his means and made it work through partnerships (labor for a home) with some friends, as well as sharing his space with others who did pay rent.
What changes is this person helping to create?	She helped ensure that emergency food aid would be available for thousands of workers, and she paved the way for future farmworker movements.	He created a sustainable lifestyle for my mother and me, and was able to retire both of my parents. This gave me a stable and love-filled house to come home to each day.

Page 8: Write It

History is often made by people who don't aspire to be famous, but those who simply refuse to accept a life of hardship for their families. Maria Moreno and my father, Scott Lomeli, are "History Makers" because they turned their personal struggles into growth for others. The purpose of this

short essay is to compare how Maria fought for the rights of migrant workers and how my father fought to change our family's economic future through decades of hard work.

Maria's journey began in the 1950s when her family faced extreme hunger in the fields following the flood of 1958 in California. After the flood, her 19-year-old son suffered from malnutrition, causing him to go blind for three days. Maria became the first woman hired as a union organizer for the AWOC, speaking out against the low wages and lack of government assistance for farmworkers. In contrast, my father's struggle was one for long-term economic stability. Coming from a lower-class background in California, he chose a career in construction due to an urgency to gain income and a lack of money for college. While Maria used her voice to organize thousands, my father built his way from the ground up to eventually supervise and look after his peers. This 30-year career later led to owning properties of his own as well as a life-long pension.

Despite their different paths, they share a similarity; both were motivated by the well-being of their [future] children. Maria wanted her children to have food and fair conditions, and my father wanted to ensure that his future family never faced the economic insecurity he saw growing up. While Maria's work impacted the public policy and labor laws, my father impacted the community in more indirect ways, such as the construction of bridges and roadways that are still in use every day. One was a public hero, and the other is a private hero, but both proved that persistence is the key to changing your future outcome for the better.

In conclusion, we can ensure these stories are remembered by documenting them and sharing the word of each of them with our younger generations to come. To continue their lessons, we should value hard work and seek personal growth every day. If we all keep working as hard as both of them, and are never afraid to speak up and change our circumstances, then this may just be the greatest generation to ever live.